# Proposal Evaluation Form

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| | **EUROPEAN COMMISSION**<br><br>Horizon Europe (HORIZON) | **Evaluation Summary Report - Innovation actions** |

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| **Call:** | HORIZON-CL5-2026-01 |
| **Type of action:** | HORIZON-IA |
| **Proposal number:** | 101318901 |
| **Proposal acronym:** | FRESHWATER |
| **Duration (months):** | 36 |
| **Proposal title:** | FRESHWATER |
| **Activity:** | HORIZON-CL5-2026-01-D6-10 |

| N. | Proposer name | Country | Total eligible costs | % | Grant Requested | % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | CT INGENIEROS AERONAUTICOS DE AUTOMOCION E INDUSTRIALES SL | ES | 752,587.5 | 7.50% | 526,811.25 | 6.38% |
| 2 | UNIVERSIDAD CARLOS III DE MADRID | ES | 562,512.5 | 5.60% | 562,512.5 | 6.82% |
| 3 | IDNEO TECHNOLOGIES SAU | ES | 671,000 | 6.68% | 469,700 | 5.69% |
| 4 | IDAERO SOLUTIONS SL | ES | 509,700 | 5.08% | 356,790 | 4.32% |
| 5 | Abaqo Ingenieria Iberia, SL | ES | 479,925 | 4.78% | 479,925 | 5.82% |
| 6 | IDEAS & MOTION SRL | IT | 408,750 | 4.07% | 286,125 | 3.47% |
| 7 | UNIVERSITA DEGLI STUDI DI MODENA E REGGIO EMILIA | IT | 587,500 | 5.85% | 587,500 | 7.12% |
| 8 | DACA-I POWERTRAIN ENGINEERING SRL. | IT | 826,625 | 8.23% | 578,637.5 | 7.01% |
| 9 | NATPOWERH S.R.L. | IT | 799,375 | 7.96% | 559,562.5 | 6.78% |
| 10 | BORD A BORD | FR | 372,750 | 3.71% | 260,925 | 3.16% |
| 11 | CT INGENIERIE | FR | 170,750 | 1.70% | 119,525 | 1.45% |
| 12 | DANMARKS TEKNISKE UNIVERSITET | DK | 770,250 | 7.67% | 770,250 | 9.33% |
| 13 | DIPOLO GMBH | DE | 482,000 | 4.80% | 337,400 | 4.09% |
| 14 | FRAUNHOFER GESELLSCHAFT ZUR FORDERUNG DER ANGEWANDTEN FORSCHUNG EV | DE | 803,312.5 | 8.00% | 803,312.5 | 9.73% |
| 15 | TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU | TR | 878,875 | 8.75% | 878,875 | 10.65% |
| 16 | SMART KONTROL SISTEMLERI VE YAZILIM ANONIM SIRKETI | TR | 394,875 | 3.93% | 276,412.5 | 3.35% |
| 17 | ISTANBUL SEHIR HATLARI TURIZM SANAYI VE TICARET ANONIM SIRKETI | TR | 569,375 | 5.67% | 398,562.5 | 4.83% |
| | Total: | | 10,040,162.5 | | 8,252,826.25 | |

**Abstract:**

The inland shipping economy is a significant sector for future economic development, which has great growth potential and can effectively improve economic resilience and enhance economic vitality. A comprehensive analysis and development should be conducted on key technologies such as Autonomous vessels, V2X Communication between vessels and port infrastructures, Hybrid powertrains, Internet of Ships, Data Spaces, Cloud Edge collaborative computing, Artificial intelligence and Geographic information systems. that support the autonomous inland waterway transportation system, as well as their development challenges. Inland waterway transport is increasingly required to operate as an integral component of digitally enabled and synchromodal logistics ecosystems, where vessels, ports, terminals and hinterland transport modes are continuously connected. Achieving this vision requires the coordinated adoption of smart vessels, automated and connected port infrastructures, and interoperable data-sharing mechanisms aligned with existing European frameworks such as River Information Services (RIS), the electronic Freight Transport Information (eFTI) regulation, and emerging mobility and logistics data spaces. Advanced technologies—including AI-driven decision support, V2X communication, edge–cloud collaborative computing, digital twins and geospatial intelligence—are key enablers to enhance operational efficiency, environmental performance and resilience.

# Evaluation Summary Report

## Evaluation Result

**Total score: 11.50 (Threshold: 10 )**

## Criterion 1 - Excellence

Score: **3.00** (Threshold: 3 / 5.00 , Weight: - )

**The following aspects will be taken into account, to the extent that the proposed work corresponds to the description in the work programme:**
**- Clarity and pertinence of the project's objectives, and the extent to which the proposed work is ambitious and goes beyond the state of the art.**
**- Soundness of the proposed methodology, including the underlying concepts, models, assumptions, inter-disciplinary approaches, appropriate consideration of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, and the quality of open science practices, including sharing and management of research outputs and engagement of citizens, civil society and end users where appropriate.**

*The clarity and pertinence of the proposed project's objectives, and the extent to which the proposed work is ambitious, and goes beyond the state of the art are good.*
*The objectives are clear.*
*However, the frequent use of claims such as "near-zero" emissions and "eliminate" pollutants, without sufficiently defined system boundaries, metrics, thresholds, or verification methods, reduces measurability and verifiability. This is a shortcoming.*
*The project addresses some aspects of the topic's scope and requirements.*
*However, bullet point 1 of the call topic scope "connecting physically and digitally IWT to existing land and waterborne multimodal logistics chains…." is not sufficiently well addressed since the project focusses rather on optimising the waterborne – port dependency, instead of targeting the overall logistic chains. This is a shortcoming.*
*Additionally, it is not sufficiently clear if all four of the demonstration pilots take place in actual operational environments as required by bullet point 3 of the call topic scope. This is a shortcoming.*
*Furthermore, "Proposing recommendations for an EU regulatory framework on harmonised smart shipping at EU level based on identified gaps and legal barriers" is not sufficiently clearly identified as a project objective in line with the call topic scope (bullet point 4). This is a shortcoming.*
*The current state of the art related to the work to be carried out in the proposed project is presented.*
*However, the SoA relies mainly on a limited number of generic web sources rather than a well assessed set of standards and peer-reviewed literature, making the basis of the project unconvincing. This is a shortcoming.*
*The proposed project shows some ambition, however the progress beyond the state of the art is only generally described.*
*More specifically, the proposal targets a fully integrated TRL 7/8 system, but it does not sufficiently detail how the various elements will be matured and validated in operational environments. For example, automated methanol bunkering and safety-compliant port integration are claimed to reach TRL 6/7, but the proposal lacks concrete evidence on operational real time tests, which makes the approach insufficiently credible. This is a shortcoming.*

*The soundness of the proposed methodology is good.*
*Methodology is presented.*
*However, the proposed steps (integrated system architecture design, model-based development and simulation, technology integration and incremental validation, operational autonomy and V2X demonstration) are not sufficiently detailed, limiting the credibility of the methodology. This is a shortcoming.*
*The proposed project is based on good concepts and models.*
*However, the proposal does not sufficiently discuss technical challenges related to latency, data reliability and integration constraints in mixed traffic environments. This is a shortcoming.*
*The proposal brings together multiple relevant disciplines.*
*However, logistics and synchromodality are not sufficiently identified. This is a shortcoming.*
*Open science practices are also not sufficiently described beyond general statements. This is a shortcoming.*
*Additionally, the involvement of end users is not sufficiently addressed and clear mechanisms for consultation and participation are not sufficiently planned for. This is a shortcoming.*

## Criterion 2 - Impact

Score: **4.00** (Threshold: 3 / 5.00 , Weight: - )

**The following aspects will be taken into account, to the extent that the proposed work corresponds to the description in the work programme:**
**- Credibility of the pathways to achieve the expected outcomes and impacts specified in the work programme, and the likely scale and significance of the contributions from the project.**
**- Suitability and quality of the measures to maximise expected outcomes and impacts, as set out in the dissemination and exploitation plan, including communication activities.**

*The credibility of the pathways and the contributions from the proposal to achieve the expected outcomes and impacts are very good.*
*All four of the expected outcomes specified in the topic are credibly addressed.*
*The proposed project's contributions to the expected outcomes are credible. KPIs and measurable metrics are well described.*
*In general the pathways to achieve the expected impacts are sufficiently credible.*
*However, the transition from successful corridor-level demonstrations to large-scale market deployment is described mainly at a strategic and narrative level, without concrete evidence of post-project investments, firm deployment roadmaps, or commitments from operators or infrastructure owners, which weakens confidence in large-scale uptake beyond the project duration. This is a shortcoming.*
*The proposal identifies some potential barriers.*
*However, key barriers (e.g. obtaining permits related to operation of autonomous vessels) are not sufficiently identified and the likelihood and severity of identified barriers are not well analysed. This is a shortcoming.*

*The suitability and quality of the communication, dissemination and exploitation measures to maximise expected outcomes and impacts are very good.*
*An adequate dissemination and communication plan is presented with measures proportionate to the scale and ambitions of the proposed project. Relevant target groups are outlined and measures tailored to their needs.*
*An exploitation strategy is provided.*
*However, the exploitation plan appears generic and lacks detailed information on how the exploitation strategy will be implemented. This is a shortcoming.*
*The strategy for the management of IPR is appropriately addressed, with relevant measures for protecting IP (patents, consortium agreement, access rights).*
*The proposal presents credible measures to provide meaningful feedback to policy by planning policy briefs and presentations at EU events involving EU and national policymakers.*

## Criterion 3 - Quality and efficiency of the implementation

Score: **4.50** (Threshold: 3 / 5.00 , Weight: - )

**The following aspects will be taken into account, to the extent that the proposed work corresponds to the description in the work programme:**
**- Quality and effectiveness of the work plan, assessment of risks, and appropriateness of the effort assigned to work packages, and the resources overall.**
**- Capacity and role of each participant, and the extent to which the consortium as a whole brings together the necessary expertise.**

*The quality and efficiency of the work plan and the appropriateness of resources overall are very good.*
*The work packages are well described and proportionate to the scale and complexity of the proposed project.*
*The timing of work packages and tasks is generally credible.*
*However, interrelation between tasks is not sufficiently clearly presented. This is a shortcoming.*
*The milestones and deliverables are sufficient and appropriate for monitoring the proposed project's progress.*
*However, the high proportion of non-public deliverables (31 out of 33 deliverables) is not sufficiently justified. This is a shortcoming.*
*The allocated effort to work packages is in line with their objectives and deliverables.*
*Relevant risks for project implementation are well identified and carefully considered. The likelihood of occurrence, the severity and corresponding work packages are properly outlined.*
*Proposed mitigation actions are adequate to help prevent and overcome the identified risks.*

*The capacity and role of each participant, and the extent to which the consortium as a whole brings together the necessary expertise are excellent.*
*The partners in the consortium bring the necessary expertise and knowledge to carry out the proposed work.*
*The consortium has appropriate complementarity, with a diverse range of entities involved in the proposed project. The overlaps between partners and their competences in areas such as digital twins and autonomy is justified by scale and complexity, supporting redundancy and robustness.*
*Partners have a valid role and sufficient resources to fulfil that role. Resources are appropriately distributed among participants in accordance with their planned activities.*
*The partners indicate access to the appropriate infrastructure needed to carry out the proposed activities.*

## Scope of the application

Status: **Yes**

**Comments (in case the proposal is out of scope)**

*Not provided*

## Exceptional funding

***A third country participant/international organisation not listed in [the General Annex to the Main Work Programme] may exceptionally receive funding if their participation is essential for carrying out the project (for instance due to outstanding expertise, access to unique know-how, access to research infrastructure, access to particular geographical environments, possibility to involve key partners in emerging markets, access to data, etc.). (For more information, see the [HE programme guide])***

**Please list the concerned applicants and requested grant amount and explain the reasons why.**

**Based on the information provided, the following participants should receive exceptional funding:**

*Not provided*

**Based on the information provided, the following participants should NOT receive exceptional funding:**

*In case the following participant is validated as international organisation but not self-assessed as International European research organisation and the proposal is invited to start grant preparation, based on the information provided in the proposal the experts consider that the following participant should not receive exceptional funding:*
*- Partner 5 ABAQO Ingeniería Iberia S.L. Grant requested: 479,925.00 €*
*The reason for not awarding the exceptional funding is that similar expertise is available in the EU. Moreover, similar expertise (developing LVC Simulator and digital twin platforms) is available within the proposed project consortium.*

## Use of human embryonic stem cells (hESC)

Status: **No**

**If YES, please state whether the use of hESC is, or is not, in your opinion, necessary to achieve the scientific objectives of the proposal and the reasons why. Alternatively, please state if it cannot be assessed whether the use of hESC is necessary or not, because of a lack of information.**

*Not provided*

## Use of human embryos

Status: **No**

**If YES, please explain how the human embryos will be used in the project.**

*Not provided*

## Activities excluded from funding

Status: **No**

**If YES, please explain.**

*Not provided*

## Exclusive focus on civil applications

Status: **Yes**

**If NO, please explain.**

*Not provided*

## Overall comments

*Not provided*

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